

ENERGY DIPLOMACY Rubio and Gor with Anant Ambani at the RIL's Jamnagar oil refinery, Oct. 21

> **"PM Modi passed the SHANTI Bill, which enables small modular reactors and technology to come to India. It is one of the first places the US is looking at to have its first SMRs"**

> **"We have always had defence partnerships. Lockheed is here, Boeing is here, co-production is happening. Jobs in India and the US are progressing hand-in-hand on these production systems"**
> **— GOR**

anything that's going on. So, our relationship with Pakistan is not new. Now, it has just developed in a way that allows us to hopefully have more influence over the decisions they make on a variety of topics. In no way does the relationship with Pakistan come at the expense of our relationship with India. We share the same concerns India does about terrorism. We have been victims of terrorism, as India has been, and continue to be. In fact, no country in the world does more to go after terrorism than the United States. It was the United States under President Trump that destroyed ISIS or Daesh in the Middle East. It's the United States that eroded Al-Qaeda. It's the United States that went in and eliminated bin Laden. It's the United States that's gone in now into parts of Africa to take on these elements as well. So, I don't think any country in the world has shown a greater commitment to go after global terrorism than the United States, and that includes many of the same ideologies that threaten India.

Q: Secretary Rubio, last year, you played an important diplomatic role during Operation Sindoor, following the terror attack in Pahalgam. On May 10, 2025, just before the ceasefire was announced, you spoke directly to the leadership on both sides. Could you take us behind the scenes of those conversations?

Rubio: Well, I won't take you behind the scenes because then no one will ever talk to me again in the future. But anytime we see a flashpoint between countries that could lead to a broader conflict and a war, we try to play a constructive role. And this was a good example of our ability to speak to multiple parties and use, in the case of both India and Pakistan, long pre-existing relationships, that I think have improved over the last few years, to ensure that there aren't flashpoints that could lead to something broader and more difficult for both. Look, the tensions that exist between the two countries are well-understood. But I can say to you with confidence that I think the United States is prepared to play a constructive role because we'd prefer not to see war. We'd prefer to see the opportunity to partner in business and commerce and do things that provide prosperity and security for the people of India, and also the people of the United States.

Q: Let's turn to defence partnerships. How far is Washington willing to go for joint production, technology transfer and developing advanced weapon systems?

Gor: Look, I mean, that has already existed in India, and continues to exist. Lockheed is here, Boeing is here, co-production is happening. Jobs in the United States and jobs in India are progressing hand-in-hand on these production systems. Our defence cooperation is at an all-time high. If you go just by the numbers, it is unmatched. In the last month alone, we had 500 US Army soldiers training here for Yudh Abhyas. We had Tarang Shakti, the first time ever F-35s have been in India to participate in a joint exercise with the Indians. Our F-35s don't go to any nation, they go to nations we trust, partners we trust. India's a very valuable partner to us in the Quad. The secretary has had multiple meetings at his level, including, by the way, another one next week at the G20 in Atlanta. Dr Jaishankar will be there, the Australians will be there, the Japanese will be there. We're also working towards a meeting between leaders, including President Trump, Prime Minister Modi, in the next month. So, there's a lot happening in the Quad. Defence goes hand-in-hand with